Klyara — Email Programme

Provider decision, full sequences, 24 newsletters (a full year), signature, deliverability

In this part

Provider decision, full sequences, 24 newsletters (a full year), signature, deliverability

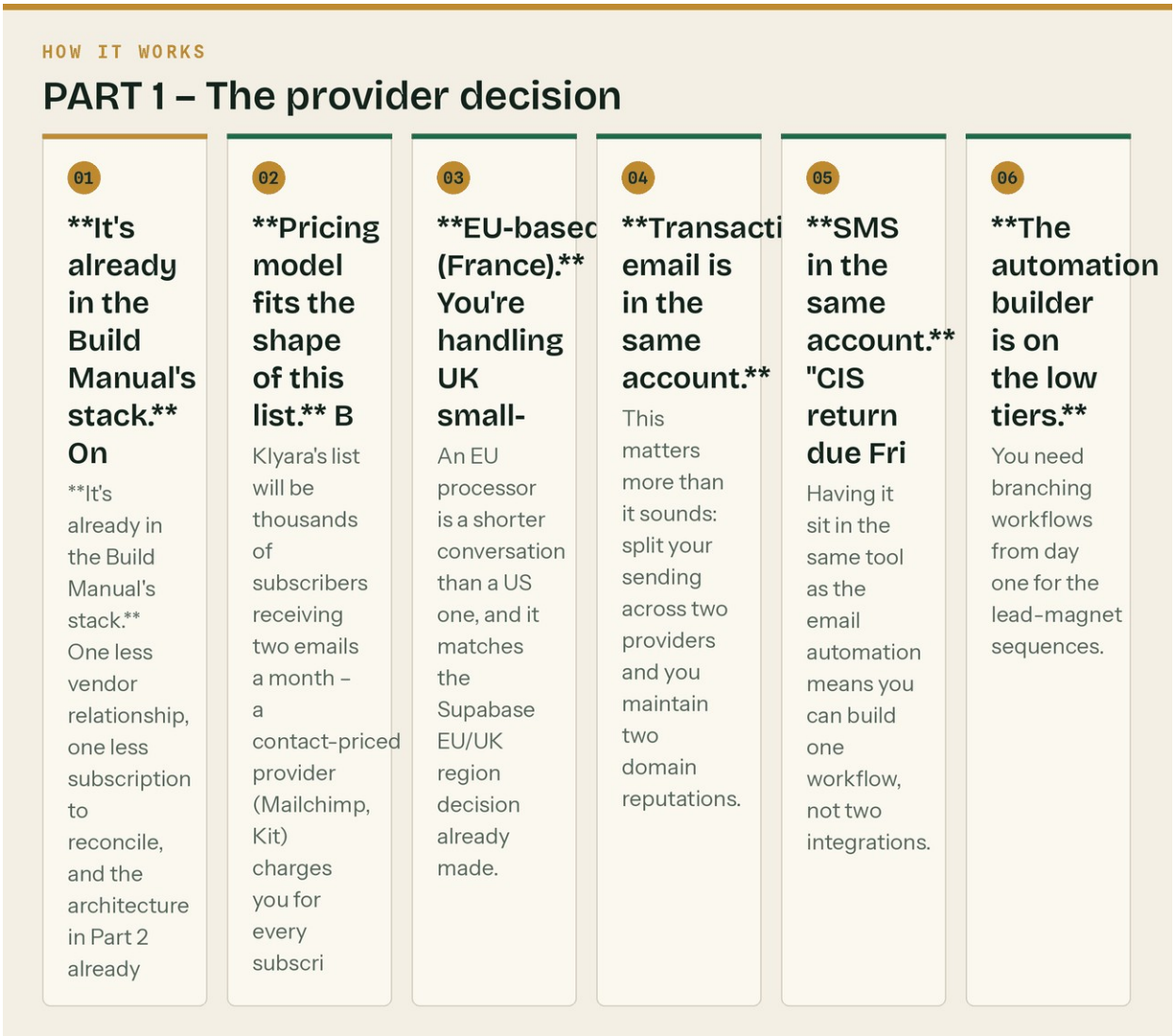
PART 1 — The provider decision

Use Brevo. Start today, free.

You asked for a decision, so: **Brevo**, and don't spend another hour comparing.

Why it's right for Klyara specifically:

1. **It's already in the Build Manual's stack.** One less vendor relationship, one less subscription to reconcile, and the architecture in Part 2 already assumes it.
2. **Pricing model fits the shape of this list.** Brevo charges by *emails sent*, not by contacts held. Klyara's list will be thousands of subscribers receiving two emails a month — a contact-priced provider (Mailchimp, Kit) charges you for every subscriber every month whether you email them or not. On a fortnightly newsletter, send-based pricing is materially cheaper, and the gap widens as the list grows.
3. **EU-based (France).** You're handling UK small-business contact data under UK GDPR, with an ICO registration and a subprocessor list in the engagement letter. An EU processor is a shorter conversation than a US one, and it matches the Supabase EU/UK region decision already made.
4. **Transactional email is in the same account.** Portal password resets, receipt-upload confirmations, invoice reminders — all from one platform, one set of DNS records, one reputation to manage. This matters more than it sounds: split your sending across two providers and you maintain two domain reputations.
5. **SMS in the same account.** "CIS return due Friday" as a text is going to outperform email with this audience by a wide margin. Having it sit in the same tool as the email automation means you can build one workflow, not two integrations.
6. **The automation builder is on the low tiers.** Kit and Mailchimp gate real automation behind expensive plans. You need branching workflows from day one for the lead-magnet sequences.



The same steps, in order.

What I considered and rejected:

- **MailerLite** — genuinely nice, slightly better editor, comparable price. Rejected only because Brevo's transactional + SMS in one account is worth more to Klyara than a nicer editor. If you already hated Brevo's UI, this is the switch.
- **Kit (ConvertKit)** — built for creators selling courses. Contact-priced, and you'd pay for the half of the list that never opens anything. Wrong shape.
- **Mailchimp** — expensive, contact-priced, and has been steadily removing things from lower tiers. No reason to choose it in 2026.
- **Zoho Campaigns** — cheap and pairs with Zoho Mail (already in the stack for mailboxes). Genuine runner-up on cost. Rejected because the automation builder is weaker and the deliverability reputation is a step below Brevo's.

The self-hosted answer, since I know you'll ask: Listmonk + Amazon SES. Listmonk is MIT-licensed, single Go binary, runs on the VPS you already have, and SES sends at roughly $0.10 per thousand emails. At 10,000 subscribers getting two emails a month it costs pennies against tens of pounds for Brevo, and you own the data outright.

Don't do it yet. Not because it's wrong — because at launch you have no list, no sending reputation, and a compliance chain to close. SES will also put you in a sandbox and make you justify your sending before granting production access, which is another queue to sit in during a launch month. Run Brevo until the list passes about **5,000 subscribers**, then migrate. Set that as a written trigger the same way the Manual sets the Dext trigger at 10–15 clients. The migration is straightforward: export CSV, import to Listmonk, re-point DNS.

Cost expectation: free while you're under 300 emails/day (that's a 4,000-person list on a fortnightly send, comfortably). First paid tier lands somewhere around £7–9/month. Confirm current pricing at signup — every provider in this space repriced at least once in the last two years.

The line that matters

SES will also put you in a sandbox and make you justify your sending before granting production access, which is another queue to sit in during a launch month.

In this part

Use Brevo. Start today, free.

PART 2 — List architecture

AT A GLANCE

What is in this part

Lists

Contact attributes to capture from day one

Ask for the absolute minimum on the form. Email and first name. That's it. Every extra field costs you con

Automation logic

Suppression rules – non-negotiable

credibility event you can't undo.

Set these up before you write a single email. Retrofitting segmentation onto a mixed list is miserable.

Lists

LIST	SOURCE	GETS
Newsletter	Site signup form	Fortnightly newsletter + welcome sequence
MTD Guide	/guide.html download	5-email MTD nurture, then joins Newsletter
Launch Kit	/launch-kit.html download	4-email digital nurture, then joins Newsletter
Solo Waitlist	MTD-threshold enquirers	Founding-rate sequence, quarterly MTD reminders
Clients	Onboarding	Operational emails only. **Never** marketing sends.
Partners	Accountants, brokers	Quarterly partner update

Contact attributes to capture from day one

```
FIRSTNAME        - personalisation, and it noticeably lifts open rates
BUSINESS_TYPE    - sole_trader | ltd | partnership
TRADE            - builder | electrician | plumber | groundworks | roofing | other
CIS_ROLE         - contractor | subcontractor | both | neither
MTD_STATUS       - in_2026 | in_2027 | in_2028 | out | unknown
SOURCE           - which magnet or channel
TOWN             - local segmentation for GBP/ads alignment
```

Ask for the absolute minimum on the form. Email and first name. That's it. Every extra field costs you conversions. Everything else gets enriched later via a one-question email (Newsletter #3 does exactly this).

Automation logic

```
Downloads MTD Guide
  → send Guide immediately (transactional)
  → 5-email MTD sequence over 12 days
  → tag MTD_STATUS from link clicks in email 2
  → move to Newsletter list
  → if clicked "I think I'm in scope" → also add to Solo Waitlist

Downloads Launch Kit
  → send Kit immediately
  → 4-email sequence over 10 days
  → move to Newsletter list

Joins Newsletter directly
  → 3-email welcome over 6 days
  → fortnightly newsletter from the next scheduled send

Books a discovery call
  → confirmation + prep email immediately
  → reminder 24h before
  → suppress from all marketing until the call outcome is logged
```

Suppression rules — non-negotiable

- **Clients never receive marketing sends.** A client getting a "join the waitlist" email is a credibility event you can't undo.
- **Anyone with a call booked** is suppressed from marketing until the outcome is recorded.
- **Hard bounces removed immediately**, soft bounces after three.
- **Unengaged after 6 months** (no open, no click) → one re-permission email → remove. A clean list of 800 outperforms a dirty list of 4,000, and this is what keeps you out of spam folders.

The line that matters

Everything else gets enriched later via a one-question email (Newsletter #3 does exactly this).

In this part

Lists · Contact attributes to capture from day one · Automation logic · Suppression rules — non-negotiable

PART 3 — Compliance, plainly

You're a bookkeeping firm holding contact data. Get this right the first time.

- **UK GDPR / PECR.** B2B email to corporate subscribers (ltd companies, LLPs) can go on legitimate interests. **Sole traders and partnerships are treated as individuals** — they need consent. Since most of your Solo audience *is* sole traders, **run the whole list on consent**. Simpler, safer, and a consented list performs better anyway.
- **Every email needs:** an unsubscribe link that works in one click, your trading name, and a postal address. Brevo handles the mechanics; you supply the address.
- **No pre-ticked boxes.** Ever.
- **Cold outreach goes from tryklyara.com**, never the main domain. This is already in the Build Manual and it's the single most important deliverability decision in the whole plan.
- **Record consent**: date, time, IP, form. Brevo logs this. Don't delete it.
- **Data processing:** add Brevo to the subprocessor list in the engagement letter and the privacy notice, alongside Supabase, Intuit and the rest.

The line that matters

Manual and it's the single most important deliverability decision in the whole plan.

Also worth knowing

Since most of your Solo audience *is* sole traders, run the whole list on consent.

PROGRESS

Part 4 of 15 – PART 3 – Compliance, plainly 27%

How far through this document you are

PART 4 — Deliverability setup (do this before the first send)

```
; SPF — one record only, never two
klyara.com.  TXT  "v=spf1 include:spf.brevo.com ~all"

; DKIM — Brevo generates the exact values; add both
mail._domainkey.klyara.com.  TXT  "k=rsa; p=<from Brevo>"

; DMARC — start at none, watch reports for two weeks, then tighten
_dmarc.klyara.com.  TXT  "v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:dmarc@klyara.com; pct=100; adkim=r; aspf=r"

; After two clean weeks of reports:
_dmarc.klyara.com.  TXT  "v=DMARC1; p=quarantine; rua=mailto:dmarc@klyara.com; pct=100"

; Then, once confident:
_dmarc.klyara.com.  TXT  "v=DMARC1; p=reject; rua=mailto:dmarc@klyara.com"

; BIMI — optional, later. Needs p=quarantine or stricter plus a VMC certificate.
; Puts the Klyara mark next to every email in Gmail. Worth it at scale, not at launch.
```

Warm-up schedule. A brand-new domain that suddenly sends 2,000 emails goes straight to spam. Ramp:

DAYS	MAX SENDS/DAY	SEND TO
1–3	20	Yourself, both founders, friends, the partner accountant
4–7	50	Earliest and warmest subscribers
8–14	150	Most engaged segment
15–21	400	Broaden
22+	Full list	Normal sending

Sender identity:

```
From name:     Craig at Klyara
From address:  craig@klyara.com
Reply-to:      craig@klyara.com   ← a real monitored inbox, not no-reply
```

A person's name in the From field outperforms a brand name substantially in B2B. And **never use no-reply@** — it suppresses replies, replies are the strongest positive deliverability signal there is, and for a service business the replies *are* the leads.

Subject line rules for this audience:

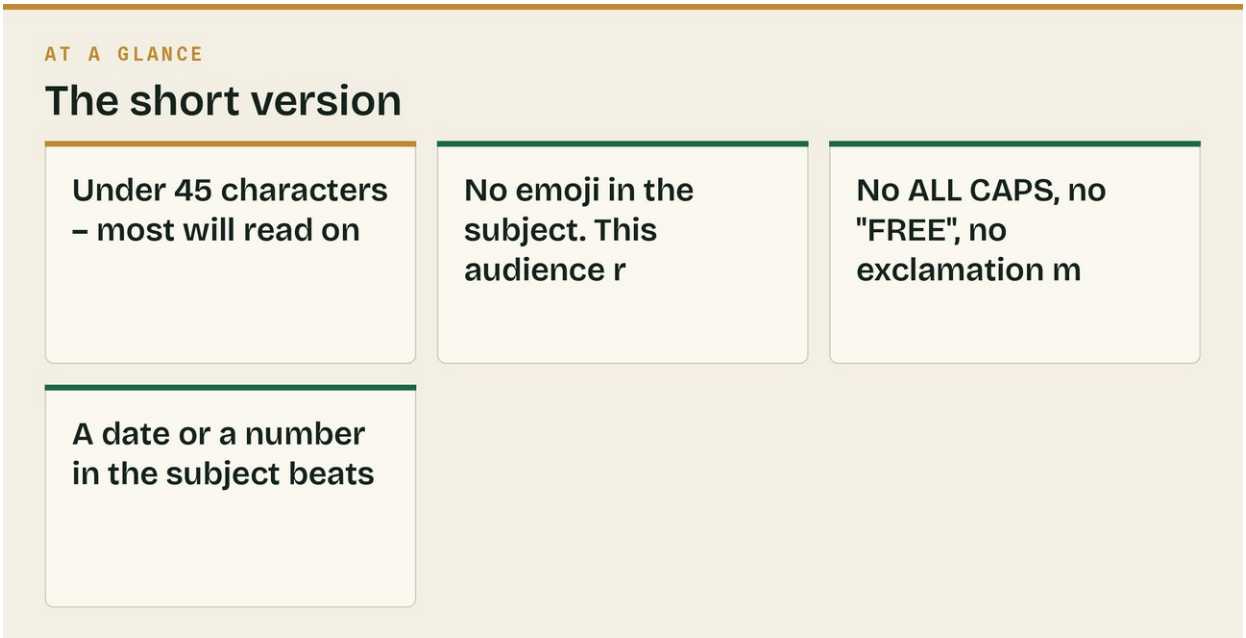
- Under 45 characters — most will read on a phone, on site, in daylight
- No emoji in the subject. This audience reads them as spam.
- No ALL CAPS, no "FREE", no exclamation marks, no "act now"
- A date or a number in the subject beats a clever line every time

The line that matters

And never use no-reply@ — it suppresses replies, replies are the strongest positive deliverability signal there is, and for a service business the replies *are* the leads.

AT A GLANCE

The short version



Also worth knowing

A person's name in the From field outperforms a brand name substantially in B2B.

PART 5 — SEQUENCE A: Newsletter welcome (3 emails, 6 days)



Trigger: signs up to the fortnightly newsletter directly.

A1 — Immediate

Subject: You're in. Here's what to expect. **Preview text:** Two emails a month. Every deadline before it bites.

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

Thanks for signing up.

Here's the deal, so you know exactly what you've agreed to:

Two emails a month. That's it. Not two a week, not one every time I have a thought.

Each one has the deadlines coming up, one thing worth knowing about CIS, VAT, MTD or getting paid,
and nothing else. No filler, no "10 productivity hacks", no motivational quotes.

If a fortnight goes by and I haven't got anything useful, you won't hear from me. I'd rather send
eleven emails a year that you read than twenty-four you delete.

Three things you can have right now, free, no forms:

📘 The MTD guide — 15 pages, plain English, whether you're in scope and what to do
   klyara.com/guide.html

🧮 Twelve calculators — job margin, CIS deduction, VAT, day rate, deadline checker
   klyara.com/tools.html

🧰 The Digital Launch Kit — 16 pages on winning work online, for firms that rely on word of mouth
   klyara.com/launch-kit.html

One more thing: hit reply and tell me what you do — builder, sparks, plumber, groundworks,
whatever it is. It takes you five seconds and it means I stop sending you things that don't apply to
you.

Craig
Klyara — the back office for small construction firms

P.S. Signing up gets you 10% off your first three months if you ever come on board. No expiry, no
```

```
pressure. It'll be here when you want it.
```

A2 — Day 3

Subject: The MTD thing that catches subbies out **Preview text:** Your bank balance is telling you the wrong number.

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

One thing, because it's caught out more people than anything else I've written about this year.

Making Tax Digital for Income Tax started in April 2026 for anyone with qualifying income over
£50,000. Most people know that bit.

Here's the bit they don't:

Qualifying income is measured GROSS. Before expenses. And before CIS deductions.

So:

  You invoiced          £55,000
  CIS took (20%)        £11,000
  You banked            £44,000

  HMRC counts           £55,000

You're over the threshold. You're in MTD. And your bank statement spent the entire year telling you
that you weren't.

If you're anywhere near that line, go and look at your gross invoices for 2024/25 — that's the year
HMRC assesses for the April 2026 start.

And if you're comfortably under: the threshold drops to £30,000 in April 2027 and £20,000 in April
2028. For a lot of subcontractors that's not a question of if, it's when.

The full guide is here, free, no email needed — you're already on the list:
klyara.com/guide.html

If you want me to just tell you whether you're in scope, reply with your rough gross invoicing for
last year and I'll tell you straight. Two minutes, no pitch.

Craig
```

A3 — Day 6

Subject: Quick question — what do you actually do? **Preview text:** One click. It stops me emailing you irrelevant things.

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

Short one.

I'd rather send you things that apply to you than things that don't, so — one click:
```

→ I'm a sole trader / self-employed
→ I run a limited company
→ I'm a subcontractor (CIS deducted from me)
→ I'm a contractor (I deduct from subbies)
→ I'm both

[each of these is a link that tags the contact and thanks them]

That's the whole email. Click one and you're done.

The next newsletter goes out on {{NEXT_SEND_DATE}}. It'll have every deadline for the month and one thing worth knowing.

Craig

P.S. If none of those fit — reply and tell me. I read them all.

The line that matters

Subject: The MTD thing that catches subbies out Preview text: Your bank balance is telling you the wrong number.

AT A GLANCE

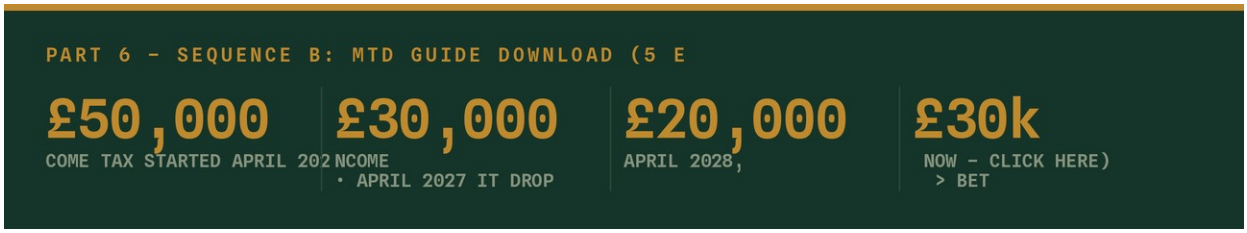
What is in this part

A1 – Immediate
Subject: You're in. Here's what to expect. Preview text: Two emails a month. Every deadline before it

A2 – Day 3
Subject: The MTD thing that catches subbies out Preview text: Your bank balance is telling you the wro

A3 – Day 6
Subject: Quick question – what do you actually do? Preview text: One click. It stops me emailing you i

PART 6 — SEQUENCE B: MTD Guide download (5 emails, 12 days)



Trigger: downloads the MTD guide. This is your highest-intent audience — they've self-identified as worried about MTD. Treat it accordingly.

B1 — Immediate (transactional)

Subject: Your MTD guide **Preview text:** Attached, and the two pages worth reading first.

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

Here's the guide: [DOWNLOAD THE MTD GUIDE →]

Fifteen pages. If you only read two of them, read pages 4 and 5 — that's the "are you actually in
scope" bit, and it's where most people find out something they didn't expect.

The short version, in case you're on site and can't open a PDF:

• MTD for Income Tax started April 2026 at £50,000 qualifying income
• April 2027 it drops to £30,000. April 2028, £20,000.
• Qualifying income is GROSS — before expenses, before CIS
• You send HMRC a summary every three months, then a final declaration on 31 January
• Quarters end 5 Jul / 5 Oct / 5 Jan / 5 Apr
• Updates are due 7 Aug / 7 Nov / 7 Feb / 7 May

Over the next couple of weeks I'll send you four more emails: whether you're in scope, what a
quarterly update actually involves, what "digital records" means in practice, and what to do if
you're behind.

Then I'll stop, and you'll just get the fortnightly newsletter like everyone else.

Craig
Klyara — the back office for small construction firms
020 8058 1496

P.S. If you'd rather just ask a human whether MTD applies to you, reply to this email. I answer them
myself and there's no pitch on the end of it.
```

B2 — Day 2

Subject: Are you actually in scope? One question. **Preview text:** It's not the number in your bank.

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

Let's settle it.

Add up your GROSS self-employment income for the 2024/25 tax year. Gross means:

  ✓ Before any expenses
  ✓ Before CIS deductions
  ✓ Before anything at all

Add any gross rental income to it.

Is that number over £50,000?

  → YES, over £50,000        (you're in MTD now — click here)
  → Between £30k and £50k    (you're in from April 2027 — click here)
  → Between £20k and £30k    (you're in from April 2028 — click here)
  → Under £20,000            (you're out for now — click here)

[each tags MTD_STATUS and sends a short tailored reply]

Two things people get wrong at this exact point:

1. They use their bank balance. If CIS is deducted from you, your bank balance is roughly 20% below
   the number HMRC is using. That gap is what puts people over the line without realising.

2. They forget the rental income. It's added to self-employment income, not assessed separately. A
   builder invoicing £40,000 with a flat bringing in £12,000 gross is over £50,000 and in scope now.

Click whichever one fits and I'll send you the bit that's actually relevant to you.

Craig
```

B3 — Day 5

Subject: What a quarterly update actually involves **Preview text:** Less than you think. Genuinely.

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

People hear "four submissions a year instead of one" and picture four tax returns.

It isn't that. Not close.

WHAT A QUARTERLY UPDATE IS

A summary of your income and expenses for that three-month period, by category, sent from compatible
software. Totals. That's the whole thing.

WHAT IT ISN'T

  ✗ Not a tax return
  ✗ Not a tax calculation
  ✗ Nothing to pay
  ✗ Not final — you can correct it later
```

✗ No reliefs or adjustments needed at this stage

All the actual tax work still happens once a year, at the final declaration on 31 January. That hasn't changed.

SO WHAT HAS ACTUALLY CHANGED?

The records. Not the return.

You now have to keep digital records as you go, rather than assembling them in one panic in January. And practically, that's the whole reform. HMRC wants the bookkeeping to happen throughout the year rather than retrospectively — and asking for four updates is how they make sure it does.

If your books are already up to date monthly, MTD is about twenty minutes a quarter.

If your books are a carrier bag in the van, MTD isn't four times the work — it's four times the panic. And that's the real reason to fix it.

Next email: what "digital records" actually means, because it's more specific than people assume and a spreadsheet may or may not be enough.

Craig

B4 — Day 8

Subject: Does a spreadsheet count? **Preview text:** Sometimes. But probably not the way you're using it.

Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

Most asked question I get on MTD. Straight answer:

A spreadsheet can be part of a compliant setup — but only if it's linked to software that can submit to HMRC, via what HMRC calls "bridging software", with digital links between the two.

"Digital links" is the important phrase. It means the data has to move electronically. Copying a figure from a spreadsheet and typing it into something else breaks the chain, and that's not compliant no matter how accurate the number is.

So in practice, for most builders: a spreadsheet plus bridging software is more moving parts, more things to go wrong, and more cost than just using proper software from the start.

WHAT DIGITAL RECORDS ACTUALLY REQUIRE

✓ Each sale recorded digitally — date, amount, category
✓ Each purchase recorded digitally — date, amount, category
✓ Records kept as you go, not reconstructed later
✓ Data flowing digitally from record to submission, no re-typing

✗ You do NOT have to photograph every receipt — but you do have to keep them, and photographing them is far easier than keeping paper in a van

THE ONE THING THAT MAKES ALL OF THIS EASY

Connect your business bank account to your software. Properly connected, feeding automatically — not

exported and typed in.

That single change does about 80% of the work of digital record-keeping on its own, and it takes ten minutes. If you do nothing else after reading this, do that.

Next one is the last of these, and it's for anyone who's reading this thinking "I'm already behind".

Craig

B5 — Day 12

Subject: If you're already behind **Preview text:** It's recoverable. Here's the order to do it in.

Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

Last one in this series.

If you're reading these thinking "this all applies to me and I've done none of it" — that's most people, and it's genuinely recoverable. It's a weekend, not a crisis.

Here's the order. Don't do them out of order, because each one makes the next one easier.

1. CONNECT THE BANK FEED. Every business account. Ten minutes. Does most of the work.

2. RECEIPTS. Every photo on your phone, every bit of paper in the van. One sitting. You're only entering the ones that aren't already on the bank feed, so it's faster than it sounds.

3. RECONCILE. Zero unmatched transactions. This is where you find the payment that came in that you never matched to an invoice — and were about to chase.

4. CIS STATEMENTS. Chase every missing payment and deduction statement now, while the contractor still remembers the job. Every unevidenced pound of CIS is tax you pay twice.

5. REVERSE CHARGE CHECK. Last ten sales invoices, four questions each. Two minutes. Highest-value two minutes on the list.

6. THE NUMBER. Margin by job, what you're owed by age, retentions outstanding, bank vs 30 days out.

That's it. That's the whole quarter-end routine, and once you've done it once it takes under an hour each time.

The full checklist is on the site as one page, free: klyara.com

⛔ HOLD-UNTIL-AML CTA:
If you'd rather not do it at all — that's what Klyara is. Bookkeeping, CIS, reverse charge coding, payroll and the MTD filing, handled monthly for a fixed fee from £59 + VAT. We open for clients shortly and I'm holding a founding rate for the first ten firms on the list. Reply "LIST" and I'll add you. No payment, no commitment.

✅ POST-AML CTA:
If you'd rather not do it at all — that's what Klyara is. Bookkeeping, CIS, reverse charge coding, payroll and MTD filing, handled monthly for a fixed fee from £59 + VAT.
Book a free 20-minute call: [BOOK A CALL →]
I'll tell you what your situation actually needs, and if that's nothing, I'll tell you that too.

Either way, you're on the fortnightly list now. Two emails a month, every deadline before it bites.

The line that matters

Subject: Your MTD guide Preview text: Attached, and the two pages worth reading first.

AT A GLANCE

What is in this part

B1 – Immediate (transactional)

Subject: Your MTD guide Preview text: Attached, and the two pages worth reading first.

B2 – Day 2

Subject: Are you actually in scope? One question. Preview text: It's not the number in your bank.

B3 – Day 5

Subject: What a quarterly update actually involves Preview text: Less than you think. Genuinely.

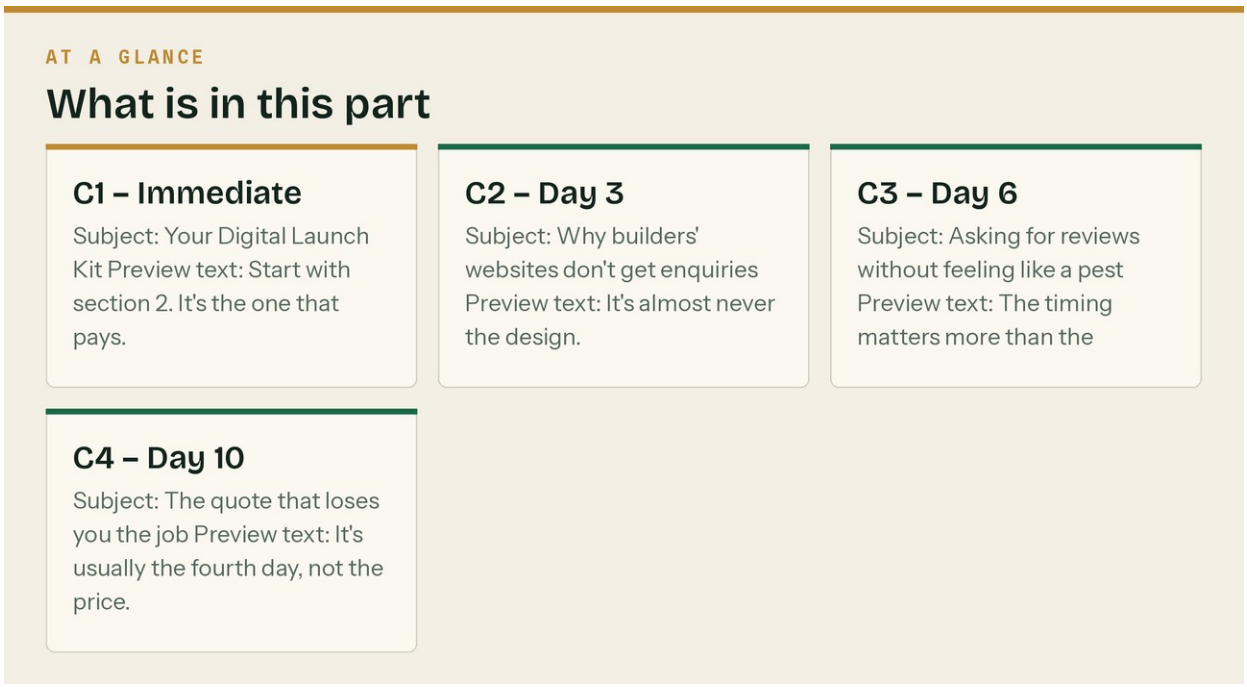
B4 – Day 8

Subject: Does a spreadsheet count? Preview text: Sometimes. But probably not the way you're using it.

B5 – Day 12

Subject: If you're already behind Preview text: It's recoverable. Here's the order to do it in.

PART 7 — SEQUENCE C: Digital Launch Kit download (4 emails, 10 days)



Trigger: downloads the Launch Kit. Different intent — these people want more work, not tax help. Do not lead with tax.

C1 — Immediate

Subject: Your Digital Launch Kit **Preview text:** Start with section 2. It's the one that pays.

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

Here it is: [DOWNLOAD THE DIGITAL LAUNCH KIT →]

Sixteen pages on winning construction work without relying entirely on word of mouth.

If you only do one thing from it, do section 2 — the Google Business Profile setup. It's free, it
takes about forty minutes, and for a local building firm it will outperform anything else in the
document, including a website.

Genuinely. A verified Google Business Profile with a dozen real reviews will bring you more work than
a £2,000 website with none.

Over the next week and a bit I'll send you three more: what actually makes a builder's website
convert, how to get reviews without feeling like a nuisance, and the quoting problem that costs firms
more work than anything else.

Craig
Klyara — the back office for small construction firms
```

020 8058 1496

C2 — Day 3

Subject: Why builders' websites don't get enquiries **Preview text:** It's almost never the design.

Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

I look at a lot of building firms' websites. The ones that don't get enquiries almost never have a design problem.

They have these problems, in this order:

1. NO PHONE NUMBER AT THE TOP
Your customer is on a phone, standing in a kitchen they want extending. They want to tap a number. If they have to scroll or find a contact page, a third of them are gone. Number top right, tappable, on every page.

2. NO PHOTOS OF ACTUAL WORK
Stock photos of a generic kitchen tell them nothing. Twelve phone photos of jobs you've actually finished tell them everything. Bad lighting is fine. Real is what matters.

3. NO AREA NAMED
"We cover the local area" ranks for nothing and reassures nobody. Name the towns. "Extensions and loft conversions in [town], [town] and [town]." That's both the SEO and the reassurance, in one line.

4. NO PRICES, NOT EVEN A RANGE
You don't have to quote. But "most of our extensions run between £X and £Y" filters out the people who were never going to proceed and massively increases the quality of the ones who call. Every firm resists this and every firm that does it gets better enquiries.

5. NO REVIEWS ON THE PAGE
Not a link to reviews. The actual words, on the page, with names. It's the single highest-converting element on any trades website.

None of that is design. All of it is content, and all of it you can fix this week on the site you've already got.

Next: getting reviews without feeling like a pest.

Craig

C3 — Day 6

Subject: Asking for reviews without feeling like a pest **Preview text:** The timing matters more than the wording.

Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

Every builder I know hates asking for reviews. Here's how to make it painless.

THE TIMING IS THE WHOLE THING

Ask when the customer is happiest. That's not when the invoice is paid — it's the moment the job is

finished and they're standing in it, looking at it.

That's the window. It's about forty-eight hours wide and most people miss it entirely, then ask three weeks later by email when the feeling's gone.

THE ASK — say this, out loud, on site

"Really glad you're happy with it. Can I ask a favour — would you mind putting a couple of lines on Google? It's the main way people find us. I'll text you the link now so you don't have to look for it."

Then text the link before you leave. From your phone, standing there.

The "I'll text you the link now" is doing all the work. An ask without a link is a request for homework, and homework doesn't get done.

WHERE TO SEND THEM

Google, first and always. It feeds your Business Profile, it shows in search results, and it's the one prospects actually look at. Trustpilot second if you want it. Ignore everything else.

THE NUMBERS THAT MATTER

Ten reviews is the threshold where a listing starts looking established. Twenty-five and you're credible. Beyond that it's about recency more than volume — five reviews in the last three months beats forty from two years ago.

Two a month, forever. That's the target. It's one ask a fortnight.

NEVER

Don't offer anything in exchange. Don't write them yourself. Don't buy them. For a firm that eventually wants a bookkeeper handling its money, being caught faking reviews is not a small thing.

Last one on Friday — the quoting problem.

Craig

C4 — Day 10

Subject: The quote that loses you the job **Preview text:** It's usually the fourth day, not the price.

Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

Last one from this series.

Most lost jobs aren't lost on price. They're lost on speed and on how the quote arrives.

SPEED
A quote sent within 24 hours wins dramatically more often than the same quote sent four days later. Not because it's better — because by day four the customer has two others and you've become the one who seemed less bothered.

If you can't get a full quote out in 24 hours, send a holding message the same day: "Thanks for seeing me today — I'll have a full quote to you by Thursday." That single text keeps you in it.

FORMAT
A number in a text message is not a quote. It's a number. And it gets compared to other numbers, which is a competition you can only lose.

A quote should have: what's included, what isn't, how long it'll take, when you could start, payment stages, and the number. On a document with your name on it.

The same price, presented properly, wins against a cheaper number in a text more often than you'd believe. You are not selling the price — you're selling the impression that you'll turn up and do what you said.

FOLLOW UP ONCE
One message, three or four days later: "Just checking you got the quote — happy to talk through any of it." That's it. One.

Most firms send none. A handful send five and become the desperate one. One is right.

THE THING NOBODY DOES
Ask why, when you lose. "No problem at all — do you mind me asking, was it price or timing?"

Half will tell you. And if the answer is consistently timing rather than price, you've just found out that you don't have a pricing problem, you have a scheduling problem — and you've been dropping your prices to fix the wrong thing.

That's the series done. You're on the fortnightly list now — two emails a month, deadlines and one useful thing.

Craig

P.S. If the reason the quotes are slow is that you're doing the books at eleven at night, that's a fixable problem and it's the one we actually solve. klyara.com

The line that matters

Subject: Asking for reviews without feeling like a pest Preview text: The timing matters more than the wording.

In this part

C1 — Immediate · C2 — Day 3 · C3 — Day 6 · C4 — Day 10

PART 8 — THE FORTNIGHTLY NEWSLETTER: 12 issues, six months, full copy



Name: *The Klyara Fortnightly* **Cadence:** Every other Thursday, 07:00 UK. Builders read email before the day starts or after they've packed up. 07:00 puts you at the top of the inbox when the phone comes off the charger.

Fixed structure — never vary it. Familiarity is why people keep opening.

```
1. DATES        — every deadline in the next fortnight. Always first. This is why they subscribed.
2. ONE THING    — the single useful piece. 300–500 words.
3. THE TOOL     — one calculator or template, linked.
4. FROM THE SITE— one link to a guide, video or post.
5. SIGN-OFF     — Craig, one line, one soft CTA.
```

Schedule:

#	DATE	THEME
1	Thu 10 Sep 2026	The gross income trap
2	Thu 24 Sep 2026	Quarter end is coming
3	Thu 8 Oct 2026	Quarter closed — the 33-day window
4	Thu 22 Oct 2026	Gross payment status
5	Thu 5 Nov 2026	Two days to the MTD deadline
6	Thu 19 Nov 2026	Pricing: what a job actually costs you
7	Thu 3 Dec 2026	The January hole
8	Thu 17 Dec 2026	Shutdown checklist
9	Thu 7 Jan 2027	31 January, and payments on account
10	Thu 21 Jan 2027	Ten days
11	Thu 4 Feb 2027	Capital allowances before 5 April

№1 — Thursday 10 September 2026

Subject: 19 Sep, and the MTD trap **Preview:** Your bank balance is telling you the wrong number.

📅 DATES

```
Sat 19 Sep — CIS return + payment, month to 5 Sep (22nd if paying electronically)
Mon 5 Oct  — MTD quarter ends (6 Jul — 5 Oct)
Sat 7 Nov  — that quarter's update due to HMRC
```

ONE THING: the number HMRC uses isn't the one in your bank

Making Tax Digital for Income Tax started in April 2026 for anyone with qualifying income over £50,000. Most people know that part.

Here's the part that's caught out more subcontractors than anything else I've written about this year: qualifying income is measured GROSS. Before expenses, and before CIS deductions.

Invoiced	£55,000
CIS took	£11,000
You banked	£44,000
HMRC counts	£55,000

You're in. Your bank statement said otherwise for twelve months.

The other thing people miss: rental income is added to it, not assessed separately. A builder invoicing £40,000 with a flat bringing in £12,000 gross is over the line right now.

Go and look at your gross invoices for 2024/25 — that's the year HMRC assesses for the April 2026 start. If it's over £50,000, you're already in, and your first update was due on 7 August.

If it wasn't, look at the year after: the threshold drops to £30,000 in April 2027 and £20,000 in April 2028.

🧮 THE TOOL: CIS deduction calculator
Work out gross-to-net either way round, including the materials split.
→ klyara.com/tools.html

📄 FROM THE SITE: the 15-page MTD guide. Free, no form.
→ klyara.com/guide.html

That's it. Back in a fortnight.

Craig
Klyara — the back office for small construction firms

Reply to this if you want me to tell you whether MTD has caught you. No pitch on the end of it.

№2 — Thursday 24 September 2026

Subject: 11 days to quarter end **Preview:** A weekend now, or a crisis in November.

📅 DATES

Mon 5 Oct — MTD quarter ends (6 Jul — 5 Oct) — 11 days
Mon 19 Oct — CIS return + payment, month to 5 Oct
Sat 7 Nov — MTD quarterly update due

ONE THING: the seven-job quarter end

If you're in MTD, everything from 6 July to 5 October needs to be in digital records by a week on Monday. If July and August are currently photos on a phone and a bag in the van, that's fixable this week. It is not fixable on 6 November.

One job a day. Each under twenty minutes.

1. BANK FEED — connect every business account. Connected and feeding, not exported and typed. Ten minutes, and it does about 80% of the work on its own.

2. RECEIPTS — every photo in the camera roll, every bit of paper. One sitting with the kettle on. Fuel, parking, tools under £100, trade counter on the personal card, PPE, the Sunday emergency run.

3. MIXED USE — van, phone, home office, workwear. Pick a defensible split, apply it consistently, write down why you picked it. HMRC has never objected to a consistent, defensible number.

4. RECONCILE — zero unmatched transactions. Watch for payments in that you never matched to an invoice. Nine times out of ten that's money you already had and were about to chase for.

5. CIS STATEMENTS — chase every missing one now, while the contractor still remembers the job. In February they won't. Every unevidenced pound of CIS is tax you pay twice.

6. REVERSE CHARGE — last ten sales invoices, four questions each. Two minutes, and it's the highest-value two minutes on this list.

7. THE NUMBER — margin by job, what you're owed by age, retentions outstanding, bank vs 30 days out.

Do one a day and you're closed off by next Thursday, six weeks ahead of the deadline.

🧮 THE TOOL: deadline checker — put your dates in, get reminders
→ klyara.com/tools.html

📄 FROM THE SITE: the quarter-end checklist as one printable page
→ klyara.com

Craig

№3 — Thursday 8 October 2026

Subject: Quarter closed. 30 days. **Preview:** Plus: the retention money you've written off.

📅 DATES

Mon 19 Oct — CIS return + payment, month to 5 Oct
Sat 7 Nov — MTD quarterly update due — 30 days
Tue 5 Jan — next MTD quarter ends

ONE THING: go and count your retentions

The quarter's closed and the update isn't due for a month, so here's something more profitable to do with the next twenty minutes.

Count your retentions. Not "roughly". Actually count them.

Three percent or five percent held back on jobs that finished a year and a half ago. Defects liability period long over. Nobody ever asked for it back, so nobody ever sent it.

In my experience a firm that does this exercise properly finds somewhere between four and fifteen thousand pounds they'd mentally written
off. Some of it genuinely isn't recoverable. A surprising amount of it is just sitting there because nobody made the phone call.

Here is the entire system:

  Job | Amount held | Release date

That's it. Three columns. Put every retention on it. Diarise the release date. Ask on the day it falls due — not three months later when you remember, by which point you're the awkward one bringing up old business.

Firms that get their retentions back aren't tougher negotiators. They're the ones who wrote it down.

And while you're at it: the same list works for what you're holding from your subbies. If you're sitting on retentions from subcontractors whose defects period ended, pay them. It costs you nothing in the long run and it's the reason good subbies pick up your calls first.

🧮 THE TOOL: retention tracker template. Free, no email.
→ klyara.com/tools.html

📄 FROM THE SITE: "Why your building firm is always skint" — the four things that drain cash while the
P&L says you're fine.
→ klyara.com

Craig

№4 — Thursday 22 October 2026

Subject: Are you lending HMRC £24,000? **Preview:** Gross payment status, and the three tests.

📅 DATES

Thu 19 Nov — CIS return + payment, month to 5 Nov
Sat 7 Nov — MTD quarterly update due — 16 days
Tue 5 Jan — next MTD quarter ends

ONE THING: gross payment status

If you're a subcontractor having 20% deducted from every invoice, and you qualify for gross payment status but have never applied — you are lending HMRC a lot of money, interest free, for up to a year.

On £120,000 of labour invoicing, that's £24,000 sat with HMRC instead of in your account. You get it back. But you get it back after you file, which could be eighteen months after you earned it.

Meanwhile you're borrowing to buy materials.

THE THREE TESTS

BUSINESS TEST — you carry out construction work in the UK, and you run it through a bank account. Straightforward for anyone actually trading.

TURNOVER TEST — your construction turnover excluding VAT and materials must be above the threshold (currently £30,000 for a sole trader, and £30,000 per director or partner for companies and partnerships, with an alternative company test). Check the current figures before applying.

COMPLIANCE TEST — this is the one that catches people. You must have filed and paid everything on time in the last twelve months. Returns, PAYE, CIS, corporation tax, the lot. HMRC does allow a small number of minor slips, but a pattern of late filing fails you.

WHY MOST PEOPLE WHO'D PASS HAVE NEVER APPLIED

No reason. They've never thought about it, or they tried once years ago, failed the compliance test, and never went back.

If you failed before: the compliance test looks at the last twelve months. Twelve clean months and you can apply again.

WORTH KNOWING: HMRC reviews gross status annually. Miss deadlines and it can be withdrawn — and losing it midway through a year is considerably worse than never having had it, because your cash flow has already adjusted.

Which is the real argument for having someone file on time every month, but I would say that.

🧮 THE TOOL: CIS calculator — see what 20% is actually costing you across a year
→ klyara.com/tools.html

Craig

№5 — Thursday 5 November 2026

Subject: MTD update due Saturday **Preview:** Two days. Here's the 40-minute version.

📅 DATES

⚠ Sat 7 Nov — MTD quarterly update DUE (6 Jul – 5 Oct) — 2 DAYS
Thu 19 Nov — CIS return + payment, month to 5 Nov
Tue 5 Jan — next MTD quarter ends

ONE THING: if it isn't done, here's the fastest legitimate route

Your quarterly update for 6 July to 5 October is due Saturday.

If you've been keeping records as you go, this is a ten-minute job — check the categories, submit.

If you haven't, here is the order that gets you there fastest:

1. Connect the bank feed. If you do nothing else, do this. It pulls three months of transactions in automatically and it's most of the job.

2. Categorise in bulk. Don't do it transaction by transaction. Sort by description, select all the fuel, categorise in one go. Then all the merchants. Then all the subbies. Twenty minutes.

3. Add the cash and personal-card purchases that aren't on the feed. Don't hunt for perfection — get the significant ones in.

4. Submit.

REMEMBER WHAT THIS SUBMISSION IS

It's a summary of totals. It isn't final, there's nothing to pay, and you can correct it later. The actual tax work happens at the final declaration on 31 January.

So: submitting something reasonable on time beats submitting something perfect late. Get it in, then tidy it up.

IF YOU GENUINELY CAN'T

Submit what you have. HMRC's late-submission penalties work on points — one late update is not a disaster, but a habit of them is. And the correction mechanism exists precisely because HMRC expects figures to be refined later.

Then spend December setting it up properly so January's quarter isn't the same weekend.

📄 FROM THE SITE: the full quarter-end checklist, one page
→ klyara.com

Craig

Reply if you're stuck. I'd rather answer a question on a Thursday than hear about a penalty in January.

№6 — Thursday 19 November 2026

Subject: What that job actually cost you **Preview:** The three costs nobody puts in the quote.

📅 DATES

Thu 19 Nov — CIS return + payment, month to 5 Nov — TODAY
Fri 18 Dec — file the CIS return for the month to 5 Dec (the 19th is a Saturday; the filing deadline does not move, so work back)
Tue 5 Jan — MTD quarter ends

ONE THING: the three costs that never make it into the quote

Most building firms price labour and materials, add a percentage, and call it a quote. Then wonder why a busy year produced no money.

Three things are missing.

1. YOUR OWN TIME, PRICED PROPERLY

Not the hours on the tools. The quoting, the site visits, the phone calls, the ordering, the chasing, the arguing about the variation. If you're on site four days and in the office two, you're charging for four days of a six-day week. Every job carries that overhead whether you price it or not.

Rule of thumb that works: for every day on site, budget half a day of everything else. Then decide whether it's in the rate or in the overhead — but decide, don't ignore it.

2. THE COST OF BEING PAID LATE

An invoice paid in 60 days instead of 30 is a job you funded for an extra month. If you're on an overdraft or a credit card to bridge it, that's real interest. If you're not, it's still real — it's the job you couldn't take because the cash was tied up.

Price the customer's payment behaviour, not just the work. The main contractor who pays in 75 days is not the same job as the private client who pays on completion, even at the same number.

3. THE JOBS THAT DIDN'T HAPPEN

If you quote six jobs to win two, the cost of the four you lost belongs in the two you won. That might be a full day of site visits and quoting. If it isn't in your pricing, you're funding your own sales process out of margin.

THE TEST

Take the last job you finished. Everything in, including the above. What did it actually make?

Most people find the answer is 8–12% below what they thought, and that the difference is entirely in these three.

🧮 THE TOOL: job margin calculator — put the last one through it
→ klyara.com/tools.html

Craig

№7 — Thursday 3 December 2026

Subject: The January hole **Preview:** It arrives every year and it surprises everyone every year.

📅 DATES

Mon 21 Dec — CIS return + payment, month to 5 Dec (19th falls on a Saturday)
Tue 5 Jan — MTD quarter ends (6 Oct — 5 Jan)
Sun 31 Jan — Final declaration + tax payment + payment on account
Sun 7 Feb — MTD quarterly update due

ONE THING: plan for January now, because January is where building firms die

Here's what happens every year.

You work through to about the 20th of December. Sites shut. Nobody's paying invoices between Christmas and New Year because the accounts departments are off.

You come back on the 5th of January. Sites are slow to restart, weather's against you, and the first two weeks are half-speed.

Then on 31 January, HMRC wants your tax bill AND your first payment on account for the following year. Which, if you had a good year, can be roughly 150% of what you were expecting.

So: five to six weeks of reduced income, followed by the single largest payment of your year.

That's the January hole. It arrives at exactly the same time every year and it surprises almost everybody.

WHAT TO DO, THIS MONTH

1. Work out what you owe on 31 January now. Not in January. Now. If you don't know, that number is the most important thing in this email.

2. Get every invoice out before the 18th of December. Anything invoiced after that sits until the second week of January regardless of your terms.

3. Chase everything outstanding this week and next. "Just tidying the books before the break" is the most socially acceptable chasing line of the entire year. Use it.

4. Don't spend December's cash on January's van. It looks like a good month. It is one month carrying two.

5. If the 31 January number is genuinely unaffordable — talk to HMRC BEFORE the deadline. A Time to Pay arrangement agreed in advance is routine. The same conversation in February, after a missed payment, is a different conversation with penalties attached.

🧮 THE TOOL: cash position forecaster
→ klyara.com/tools.html

Craig

№8 — Thursday 17 December 2026

Subject: Before you shut down **Preview:** Nine things, one hour, and January is 40% easier.

📅 DATES

Mon 21 Dec — CIS return + payment, month to 5 Dec
Tue 5 Jan — MTD quarter ends (6 Oct — 5 Jan)
Sun 31 Jan — Final declaration + tax payment + payment on account
Sun 7 Feb — MTD quarterly update due

ONE THING: the shutdown checklist

One hour before you finish. It makes January materially easier.

☐ 1. Every invoice out. Everything you've done that isn't invoiced, invoice today. Anything after tomorrow sits until the second week of January anyway.

☐ 2. Chase everything outstanding. "Just tidying up before the break" — the most acceptable chasing line of the year, and it works.

☐ 3. CIS return for the month to 5 December — due Monday 21st. Don't leave it in the pile.

☐ 4. Receipts in. Three months of them, one sitting. You'll thank yourself in the first week of January when the quarter closes on the 5th.

☐ 5. Chase missing CIS deduction statements. Contractors are shutting down too — after Christmas they'll have forgotten which job you mean.

☐ 6. Know your 31 January number. If you don't know it, find out this week. There is no version of January where that number is better news than it is now.

☐ 7. Diary the January dates: quarter ends 5th, tax due 31st, quarterly update due 7 February.

☐ 8. Tell your customers when you're back. One text. It stops the "are you around?" messages on Boxing Day and it gets you first in the queue for January starts.

☐ 9. Book the first week of January lighter than you think. It always goes slower than planned and an over-booked first week is how the whole month gets behind.

Have a proper break. The paperwork will still be there and it will not have got worse.

Back on 7 January.

Craig

№9 — Thursday 7 January 2027

Subject: 31 January: two payments, not one **Preview:** The payment on account catches people out every year.

📅 DATES

Tue 19 Jan — CIS return + payment, month to 5 Jan
Sun 31 Jan — Final declaration + balancing payment + payment on account
Sun 7 Feb — MTD quarterly update due (6 Oct — 5 Jan)

ONE THING: what's actually due on 31 January

This catches people every single year, so:

On 31 January you may be paying TWO things.

1. THE BALANCING PAYMENT — what you owe for the tax year that ended 5 April 2026, less anything you've already paid on account and less any CIS already deducted from you.

2. THE FIRST PAYMENT ON ACCOUNT for the current year — normally 50% of last year's tax bill, paid in advance.

Then a second payment on account follows on 31 July.

So if your bill for the year was £6,000 and you had nothing on account, 31 January is £6,000 plus £3,000 = £9,000. Not £6,000.

The first year this happens is brutal, because it's 150% of a number you were already dreading. After that it settles into a rhythm — but the first one has ended more building firms than bad weather has.

IF YOU'RE A CIS SUBCONTRACTOR, READ THIS BIT

Every pound of CIS deducted from you during the year counts toward this bill. If 20% has been coming off all year, there's a decent chance you're owed a refund rather than owing anything.

But — and this is the whole point — you can only claim the deductions you can evidence. If you're missing payment and deduction statements, you can't claim them, and you'll pay that tax twice.

Chase the missing ones this week. It is the highest-value hour available to you in January.

YOU CAN REDUCE PAYMENTS ON ACCOUNT

If you know this year will be lower than last, you can apply to reduce them. Be careful: reduce them too far and HMRC charges interest on the shortfall. Reduce on evidence, not on optimism.

IF YOU CAN'T PAY

Talk to HMRC before 31 January. Time to Pay arrangements are routine and they're set up online for smaller amounts. The conversation before the deadline is administrative. The one after it involves penalties.

🧮 THE TOOL: CIS calculator + deadline checker
→ klyara.com/tools.html

Craig

№10 — Thursday 21 January 2027

Subject: Ten days **Preview:** 31 January. And what to do if the number's wrong.

📅 DATES

⚠ Sun 31 Jan — Final declaration + balancing payment + payment on account — 10 DAYS
Sun 7 Feb — MTD quarterly update due (6 Oct — 5 Jan)
Fri 19 Feb — CIS return + payment, month to 5 Feb

ONE THING: ten days, in order

☐ TODAY — file it if it isn't filed. Even if you can't pay. The late FILING penalty and the late PAYMENT penalty are separate things. Filing on time and paying late costs you far less than doing neither, and it takes the worst penalty off the table entirely.

☐ TODAY — if you can't pay, set up Time to Pay. It's online for smaller balances. Do it before the 31st.

☐ THIS WEEK — chase every missing CIS deduction statement. Unevidenced deductions are tax you pay twice. This is the last useful week to chase them.

☐ THIS WEEK — check whether your payment on account should be reduced. Only on evidence. Reduce it on optimism and HMRC charges interest on the difference.

☐ BEFORE THE 31st — check the figures actually look right. The commonest errors I see: CIS deductions entered as income, materials included in the CIS deduction calculation, and the payment on account forgotten entirely.

☐ THE 31st — pay. Allow for clearing time if you're not paying by card or faster payment.

☐ 1 FEBRUARY — put 7 February in the diary. Your MTD quarterly update for 6 Oct to 5 Jan is due a week later, and every year people file on the 31st, exhale, and miss it.

AND THEN

When it's done, do one thing: work out what you'll owe next 31 January, and start putting it aside

monthly.

A separate account, a standing order, 25–30% of what lands. It is the single change that turns January from an event into a date.

Everyone knows this. Almost nobody does it. The ones who do never have a bad January again.

Craig

If it's gone wrong and you want someone to look at it — reply. I'd rather help in January than hear about it in June.

№11 — Thursday 4 February 2027

Subject: Buying a van before April? **Preview:** The timing is worth more than the haggling.

📅 DATES

Sun 7 Feb — MTD quarterly update due (6 Oct – 5 Jan) — 3 days
Fri 19 Feb — CIS return + payment, month to 5 Feb
Mon 5 Apr — Tax year ends · MTD quarter ends
Apr 2027   — MTD threshold drops to £30,000

ONE THING: capital allowances, and why the date on the invoice matters

Two months left in the tax year. If you're planning to buy anything substantial — van, plant, machinery, a decent run of tools — the date it goes on the invoice decides which tax year it lands in.

THE BASICS

Most plant, machinery, tools and commercial vehicles qualify for the Annual Investment Allowance, which lets you deduct the full cost from your profits in the year you buy it, up to a generous annual limit that most small firms will never reach.

Full deduction. In year one. Not spread over the life of the asset.

WHY THE TIMING MATTERS

Buy on 3 April and it comes off this year's profit. Buy on 8 April and it comes off next year's.

Same van. Same money. Different year, and possibly a different tax rate.

The right answer depends on which year has the higher profit. If this year was strong and next looks quieter — buy before 5 April. If this year was quiet and you're booked solid from April — wait.

That is a genuine decision worth making deliberately, and it's worth more than anything you'll achieve by haggling on the price.

THREE THINGS TO WATCH

1. CARS ARE DIFFERENT. Cars generally don't get the Annual Investment Allowance and are treated

under separate rules based on emissions. A commercial vehicle — a van, a pickup that genuinely qualifies — is treated as plant and machinery. The line between "van" and "car" for tax has been litigated and it is not always obvious. Check before you buy, not after.

2. FINANCE MATTERS. Hire purchase usually gets the allowance on the full cost when the asset is brought into use. A lease usually doesn't work that way at all. The finance structure changes the tax treatment substantially.

3. IT HAS TO BE IN USE. Ordered isn't enough. It generally needs to be in use in the business by the year end.

DON'T BUY THINGS FOR TAX REASONS

Worth saying plainly: spending £30,000 to save tax at 20% leaves you £24,000 worse off in cash. If you need the van, the timing is worth optimising. If you don't need the van, no amount of tax relief makes it a good purchase.

Craig

№12 — Thursday 18 February 2027

Subject: £30,000 from April. That's most subbies. **Preview:** Six weeks. And this wave is much bigger than the first.

📅 DATES

Fri 19 Feb — CIS return + payment, month to 5 Feb
Mon 5 Apr — Tax year ends · MTD quarter ends (6 Jan — 5 Apr)
Apr 2027 — ⚠ MTD threshold drops to £30,000
Fri 7 May — MTD quarterly update due

ONE THING: the £30,000 wave

From April 2027, Making Tax Digital for Income Tax applies to anyone with qualifying income over £30,000.

The first wave, at £50,000, caught established sole traders and larger subbies. This one is different.
£30,000 gross is a working subcontractor. It's most of the trade.

And qualifying income is still measured GROSS — before expenses, before CIS. So:

  £30,000 gross invoicing is roughly £24,000 in the bank after 20% CIS.
  £24,000 in the bank puts you in MTD.

If you're a subbie who assumed this didn't apply to you, check the number you invoiced, not the number you banked.

WHAT TO DO IN THE NEXT SIX WEEKS

1. WORK OUT IF YOU'RE IN. Gross self-employment income plus gross property income for 2025/26. Over

£30,000, you're in from April 2027.

2. START THE DIGITAL RECORDS NOW, NOT IN APRIL. The single biggest mistake the first wave made was waiting for the start date. Get the bank feed connected and the receipts flowing this month, and April is a non-event. Leave it to April and your first quarter is a panic.

3. GET COMPATIBLE SOFTWARE. Whatever you use has to be able to submit to HMRC.

4. PUT THE DATES IN. Quarters end 5 Jul, 5 Oct, 5 Jan, 5 Apr. Updates due 7 Aug, 7 Nov, 7 Feb, 7 May.

THE HONEST VERSION

If your books are already running monthly, MTD is about twenty minutes a quarter and this email is nothing to worry about.

If they're a bag in the van, MTD doesn't create four times the work — it creates four times the panic, and it does it forever. Which is why the sensible move is to fix the bookkeeping between now and April rather than to fix the deadline in August.

🧮 THE TOOL: MTD scope checker + deadline reminders
→ klyara.com/tools.html

📄 FROM THE SITE: the 15-page MTD guide, updated for the £30,000 threshold
→ klyara.com/guide.html

That's six months of these. Thank you for reading them.

If the answer to all of this is "I need someone to just handle it" — that's what Klyara is. Bookkeeping, CIS, reverse charge, payroll and the quarterly filing, for a fixed monthly fee from £59 + VAT. Twenty-minute call, no pitch: klyara.com

Craig

The line that matters

Fixed structure — never vary it. Familiarity is why people keep opening.

AT A GLANCE

What is in this part

1 – Thursday 10 September 2026

Subject: 19 Sep, and the MTD trap Preview: Your bank balance is telling you the wrong number.

2 – Thursday 24 September 2026

Subject: 11 days to quarter end Preview: A weekend now, or a crisis in November.

3 – Thursday 8 October 2026

Subject: Quarter closed. 30 days. Preview: Plus: the retention money you've written off.

4 – Thursday 22 October 2026

Subject: Are you lending HMRC £24,000? Preview: Gross payment status, and the three tests.

5 – Thursday 5 November 2026

Subject: MTD update due Saturday Preview: Two days. Here's the 40-minute version.

6 – Thursday 19 November 2026

Subject: What that job actually cost you Preview: The three costs nobody puts in the quote.

PART 9 — Transactional emails

AT A GLANCE

What is in this part

Discovery call booked – confirmation
Subject: Booked: {{DATE}} at {{TIME}}

Reminder – 24 hours before
Subject: Tomorrow at {{TIME}}

Guide download – the delivery email
Subject: Your {{GUIDE_NAME}}

Waitlist confirmation (pre-AML)
Subject: You're on the list

Discovery call booked — confirmation

Subject: Booked: {{DATE}} at {{TIME}}

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

You're booked in for {{DATE}} at {{TIME}}. I'll call you on {{PHONE}}.

It'll take about twenty minutes. Nothing to prepare, but if you can have these to hand it makes it
more useful:

  • Roughly what you invoiced last year, gross
  • Whether you're a sole trader or a limited company
  • Whether CIS is deducted from you, or you deduct from others, or both
  • What you currently use for the books, if anything

I'll tell you what your situation actually needs. If that's nothing, or if it's something we don't
do, I'll tell you that — it's a twenty-minute call, not a sales process.

Need to move it? Reschedule here: {{RESCHEDULE_LINK}}

Craig
020 8058 1496
```

Reminder — 24 hours before

Subject: Tomorrow at {{TIME}}

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

Quick reminder — I'm calling you tomorrow at {{TIME}} on {{PHONE}}.

If you're on site and it's a bad time, just move it: {{RESCHEDULE_LINK}}. Genuinely no problem, it's
easier than trying to talk over a breaker.

Craig
```

Guide download — the delivery email

Subject: Your {{GUIDE_NAME}}

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

Here you go: [DOWNLOAD →]

If the link doesn't work, reply and I'll send it as an attachment.

Craig
Klyara — 020 8058 1496
```

Waitlist confirmation (pre-AML)

Subject: You're on the list

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

You're on the founding list.

What that means: when we open for clients, you get first call and the founding rate held for as long
as you stay with us. No payment now, nothing to sign, and you can tell me to get lost at any point.

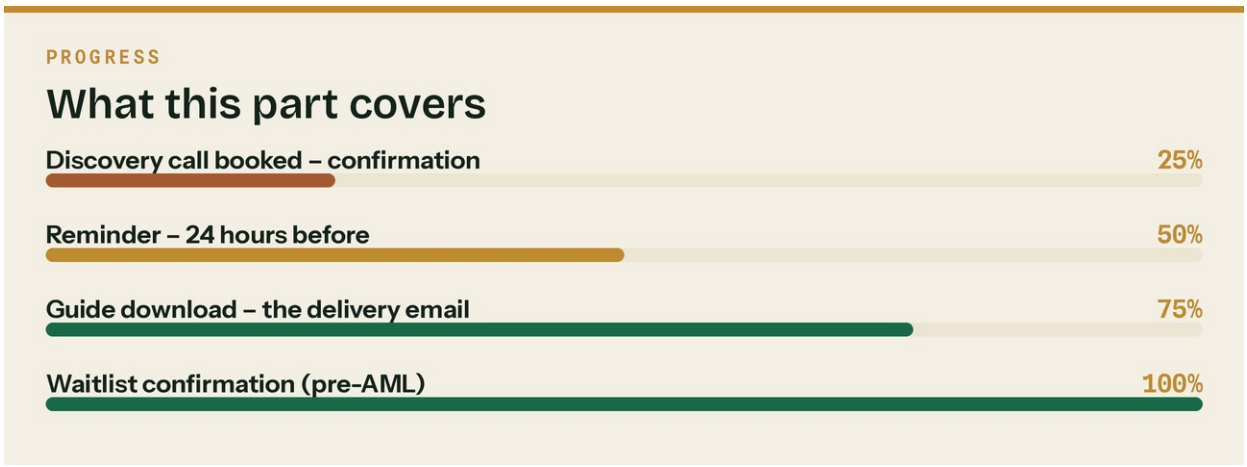
I'll email you when we open — realistically {{TIMEFRAME}}. In the meantime you'll get the fortnightly
newsletter: every deadline before it bites, and one useful thing.

If anything urgent comes up before then, ring me. 020 8058 1496.

Craig
```

In this part

Discovery call booked — confirmation · Reminder — 24 hours before · Guide download — the delivery email · Waitlist confirmation (pre-AML)



Read top to bottom. The bar is just how far through the part you are.

PART 10 — Email signature

Two versions, both in the delivered files: email/signature.html (rich) and the plain-text fallback below. Keep signatures **under 4 lines of actual content** — long signatures with social icons and quotes read as amateur in B2B and add weight to every email in the thread.

Plain text version:

```
--
Craig {{SURNAME}}
Klyara — the back office for small construction firms

020 8058 1496  |  craig@klyara.com  |  klyara.com
Bookkeeping · CIS · VAT reverse charge · Payroll · Making Tax Digital
```

Do not include: a confidentiality disclaimer nobody reads, a "please consider the environment" line, social media icon rows, or an image-only signature (it breaks in dark mode and triggers spam filters).

Do include, once supervised: your professional body membership line and AML supervision reference. For a bookkeeping firm that is a genuine trust signal and it belongs in the signature:

```
{{ICB/AAT}} member in practice · AML supervised by {{BODY}} · Practice licence {{NUMBER}}
```

The line that matters

Do not include: a confidentiality disclaimer nobody reads, a "please consider the environment" line, social media icon rows, or an image-only signature (it breaks in dark mode and triggers spam filters).

Also worth knowing

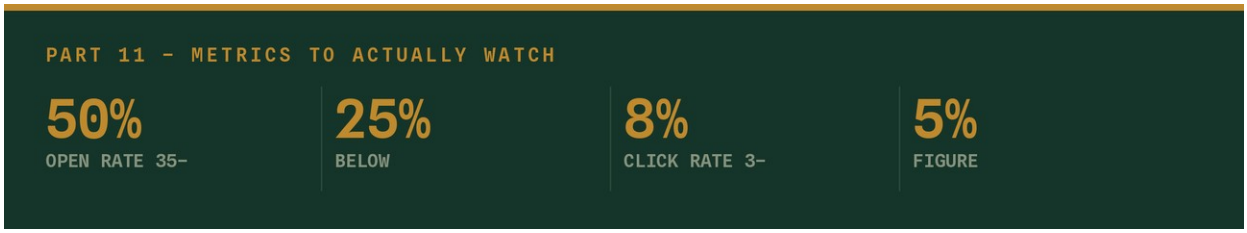
Keep signatures under 4 lines of actual content — long signatures with social icons and quotes read as amateur in B2B and add weight to every email in the thread.

PROGRESS

Part 11 of 15 – PART 10 – Email signature 73%

How far through this document you are

PART 11 — Metrics to actually watch



Ignore vanity metrics. Four numbers, monthly:

METRIC	HEALTHY FOR B2B TRADE AUDIENCE	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
Open rate	35–50%	Subject lines and list quality. Below 25% = list hygiene problem.
Click rate	3–8%	Whether the content earns action
Reply rate	**Track this above everything**	The only metric that turns into revenue. Replies are leads.
Unsubscribe	Under 0.5% per send	Above 1% means wrong audience or wrong frequency

The one that matters is replies. Every sequence above is written to invite one. A newsletter with a 30% open rate and eight replies is worth more to Klyara than one with 60% opens and none.

PART 12 — The recurring client emails

AT A GLANCE

What is in this part

Records reminder – the 5th of each month
Subject: Records for {{MONTH}} – by the 10th

Late records – the 11th, only if needed
Subject: Still waiting on {{MONTH}}

CIS filed – the 19th
Subject: CIS filed for {{MONTH}}

Monthly reports – by the 10th
Subject: {{MONTH}} figures

VAT return filed – quarterly
Subject: VAT return filed – {{QUARTER}}

MTD quarterly update filed
Subject: MTD update filed – {{QUARTER}}

Not marketing. These are the operational emails that run every month for every client, forever. Automate them in Brevo against the client list, or send from the practice inbox — but write them once and stop rewriting them.

These go to the Clients list, which never receives marketing sends. See §Suppression rules.

Records reminder — the 5th of each month

Subject: Records for {{MONTH}} — by the 10th

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

Quick nudge: anything for {{MONTH}} that isn't already in the app, we need by the 10th.

Most of it should be in already if you've been snapping receipts as you go. The ones that usually
aren't:
• Anything paid in cash
• Trade counter purchases on a personal card
• Invoices you raised but haven't put through

Nothing to send if it's all in — ignore this.

Craig
```

Late records — the 11th, only if needed

Subject: Still waiting on {{MONTH}}

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

We're missing {{WHAT}} for {{MONTH}}.

Not chasing for the sake of it — the CIS return has to go in by the 19th and I'd rather not file it
on incomplete figures.

If it's easier, ring me and we'll go through what's outstanding in five minutes.

Craig
020 8058 1496
```

The late-records surcharge is in the engagement letter. Warn once, apply it the second time. It almost never needs applying twice.

CIS filed — the 19th

Subject: CIS filed for {{MONTH}}

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

CIS return for the month to {{DATE}} is filed.

Deducted this month: {{AMOUNT}}
Due to HMRC by: {{22nd or 19th}}
Subcontractors on the return: {{N}}

Payment and deduction statements have gone out to all of them.

{{ANY FLAG — an unverified subbie, a missing statement, something odd. If nothing, delete this
line.}}

Craig
```

Monthly reports — by the 10th

Subject: {{MONTH}} figures

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

{{MONTH}} is in the portal.

Turnover              {{X}}
Gross margin          {{X}}
Owed to you           {{X}}  (over 60 days: {{X}})
Retentions outstanding {{X}}
Bank vs next 30 days  {{X}}

{{ONE OBSERVATION. The single most useful thing in the numbers, in one sentence. Never more than
one — if there are three things worth saying, ring them instead.}}

Nothing needed from you.
```

```
Craig
```

VAT return filed — quarterly

Subject: VAT return filed — {{QUARTER}}

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

VAT return for {{QUARTER}} is filed.

{{Payable / Repayable}}: {{AMOUNT}}
{{Due by / Expected}}: {{DATE}}

{{If repayable and it's a pattern: "That's the third quarter running you've been in repayment. Worth
moving to monthly returns — you'd get the money back twelve times a year instead of four. Say the
word and I'll apply."}}

Craig
```

MTD quarterly update filed

Subject: MTD update filed — {{QUARTER}}

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

Your quarterly update for {{PERIOD}} has gone to HMRC.

Nothing to pay on it — it's a summary, not a calculation. The tax gets settled at the final
declaration on 31 January.

Next quarter ends {{DATE}}, due {{DATE}}.

Craig
```

Deadline warning — 14 days before anything with a date

Subject: {{DEADLINE}} — {{DATE}}

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

{{DEADLINE}} falls on {{DATE}}, two weeks today.

{{What we need from you, or "nothing needed — it's handled".}}

{{If money is due: the amount, and where it goes.}}

Craig
```

Year end pack

Subject: Year end — everything your accountant needs

```
Hi {{FIRSTNAME}},

Year end pack is ready and I've sent it to {{ACCOUNTANT}}.

What went over: trial balance, reconciled control accounts, CIS reconciled to your deduction
statements, aged debtors and creditors, retention schedule, fixed asset movements, and the bank
reconciliations.

They shouldn't need to come back to you for anything. If they do, send it to me rather than digging
it out yourself.

Craig
```

The 90-day and six-monthly review invite

See docs/12 §Part 2, Email 5. Diarise it at onboarding — it is the most commonly skipped email in this list and the one that produces the add-on revenue.

Automating these

In Brevo, most of these are date-triggered rather than behaviour-triggered:

```
5th of month       Records reminder      → Clients list
11th of month      Late records          → manual, only where needed
19th of month      CIS filed             → per client, after filing
By the 10th        Monthly reports       → per client, after reports published
Quarterly          VAT filed             → per VAT client
Quarterly          MTD filed             → per Solo client
-14 days           Deadline warning      → per applicable deadline
Day 85             90-day review invite  → set at onboarding
```

Do not fully automate the ones carrying figures. A wrong number sent automatically is worse than a late email. Automate the trigger and the template; type the numbers.

The line that matters

These go to the Clients list, which never receives marketing sends. See §Suppression rules.

In this part

Records reminder — the 5th of each month · Late records — the 11th, only if needed · CIS filed — the 19th · Monthly reports — by the 10th · VAT return filed — quarterly · MTD quarterly update filed

PART 13 — Newsletters 13–24: the second six months



Issues 1–12 cover September 2026 to February 2027. These carry it through to August 2027, so the programme runs a full year without you writing anything.

#	DATE	THEME
13	Thu 4 Mar 2027	Five weeks to year end
14	Thu 18 Mar 2027	Buying before 5 April
15	Thu 1 Apr 2027	The £30,000 wave lands Monday
16	Thu 15 Apr 2027	Your first quarter under MTD
17	Thu 29 Apr 2027	The receipt habit
18	Thu 13 May 2027	Verification, and the 30% trap
19	Thu 27 May 2027	Why busy firms are skint
20	Thu 10 Jun 2027	Quoting and winning work
21	Thu 24 Jun 2027	Quarter end, 5 July
22	Thu 8 Jul 2027	31 July payment on account
23	Thu 22 Jul 2027	Mid-year: gross payment status
24	Thu 5 Aug 2027	MTD update due Saturday

№13 — Thu 4 March 2027

Subject: Five weeks to year end **Preview:** Five things worth doing before 5 April.

📅 DATES

```
Fri 19 Mar — CIS return, month to 5 Mar
Mon 5 Apr  — Tax year ends. MTD quarter ends. £30,000 threshold begins.
Mon 19 Apr — CIS return, month to 5 Apr
Fri 7 May  — MTD quarterly update due
```

ONE THING: five things before 5 April

Nothing here is dramatic. All of it is harder in June.

1. GET EVERY INVOICE OUT. Anything you have done and not invoiced belongs in this tax year. Sitting on it does not defer the tax, it just makes the records wrong.

2. GET EVERY RECEIPT IN. The ones people lose money on are always the same: fuel, parking, tools under £100, trade counter on a personal card, PPE.

3. DECIDE ON ANY PURCHASE. The invoice date decides which tax year it lands in. If this year was strong and next looks quieter, buy before 5 April. If the reverse, wait. It has to be in use in the business by the year end, not just ordered.

4. CHECK GROSS PAYMENT STATUS. The compliance test looks at the last twelve months. If those twelve months are clean and your construction turnover clears the threshold, you would pass — and most firms who would pass have never applied.

5. CHASE MISSING CIS STATEMENTS. Every deduction you cannot evidence is tax you pay twice.

🧮 THE TOOL: CIS calculator and deadline checker → klyara.com/tools.html

Craig

№14 — Thu 18 March 2027

Subject: Buying a van before April? **Preview:** The date on the invoice is worth more than the haggling.

📅 DATES

Fri 19 Mar — CIS return, month to 5 Mar — tomorrow
Mon 5 Apr — Tax year ends · MTD £30,000 threshold begins
Fri 7 May — MTD quarterly update due

ONE THING: capital allowances, and the two-week decision

If you are buying a van, plant, or a serious run of tools, the date on the invoice decides which tax year the deduction falls in.

THE BASICS

Most plant, machinery, tools and commercial vehicles qualify for the Annual Investment Allowance — the full cost off your profits in the year of purchase, not spread over the life of the asset.

WHY THE TIMING MATTERS

Buy on 3 April and it comes off this year. Buy on 8 April and it comes off next year. Same van, same money, potentially a different rate of tax.

The right answer depends on which year has the higher profit. Strong year now and a quieter

one ahead — buy before 5 April. The other way round — wait. That decision is worth more than anything you will achieve arguing about the price.

THREE THINGS TO WATCH

Cars are treated differently from commercial vehicles, and the line between them for tax has been litigated more than once. Check before you buy, not after.

Hire purchase usually gets the allowance on the full cost when the asset is brought into use. A lease usually does not work that way at all.

And it has to be in use in the business by the year end. Ordered is not enough.

DO NOT BUY THINGS FOR TAX REASONS

Spending £30,000 to save tax at 20% leaves you £24,000 down. If you need the van, optimise the timing. If you do not, no amount of relief makes it a good purchase.

Craig

№15 — Thu 1 April 2027

Subject: £30,000 from Monday **Preview:** Measured on what you invoiced, not what you banked.

📅 DATES

⚠ Mon 5 Apr — Tax year ends. MTD applies at £30,000 qualifying income.
Mon 19 Apr — CIS return, month to 5 Apr
Fri 7 May — MTD quarterly update due (6 Jan — 5 Apr)

ONE THING: the wave that catches most of the trade

From Monday, Making Tax Digital for Income Tax applies to anyone with qualifying income over £30,000.

HMRC's wording is "the amount before expenses (also known as turnover), based on the tax return you submitted in the previous tax year".

The bit that matters for anyone in CIS: deductions do not reduce your turnover. They sit in a separate box on your return as tax you have already paid. So £30,000 of turnover is roughly £24,000 in the bank after 20% comes off.

Which means a subbie who banked £24,000 is in. And their bank statement spent the whole year suggesting otherwise.

Add property income too — it is combined, not assessed separately. Invoice £24,000 with a flat bringing in £8,000 gross and you are at £32,000.

CHECK IT PROPERLY

Find your 2025–26 return. Look at the turnover box on the self-employment pages, not the profit and not the bank. Add gross property income. That total is the number.

WHAT TO DO IF YOU ARE IN

Connect your business bank account to compatible software. That single step does most of the work, takes about ten minutes, and everything else follows from it.

Then put four dates in your phone: quarters end 5 Jul, 5 Oct, 5 Jan, 5 Apr. Updates due on the 7th of the following month.

📘 Free 15-page MTD guide, no email needed → klyara.com/guide.html

Craig

№16 — Thu 15 April 2027

Subject: Your first quarter **Preview:** Less than the panic suggests.

📅 DATES

Mon 19 Apr — CIS return, month to 5 Apr
Fri 7 May — MTD quarterly update due (6 Jan — 5 Apr)
Mon 5 Jul — Next MTD quarter ends

ONE THING: what a quarterly update actually involves

If April was your first month in MTD, here is the whole thing.

You keep digital records as you go. At the end of each quarter you send HMRC a summary of income and expenses by category, from compatible software. Totals. That is the submission.

It is not a tax return. Nothing is calculated. Nothing is due. Nothing is final — you can correct figures later. The tax is still settled once a year at the final declaration on 31 January, exactly as it always was.

So the change is the record keeping, not the return. Asking for four updates a year is simply how HMRC makes sure the bookkeeping happens throughout the year rather than retrospectively.

IF YOUR BOOKS ARE CURRENT: about twenty minutes a quarter.
IF THEY ARE NOT: MTD does not create four times the work. It creates four times the panic, permanently. Which is the real reason to fix it now rather than in July.

THE ONE HABIT

Photograph the receipt at the counter. Ten seconds, while you are standing there. Not collected in the van, not sorted at the weekend. That single habit is the difference between this being easy and this being a quarterly argument.

Craig

№17 — Thu 29 April 2027

Subject: Ten seconds at the counter **Preview:** The habit that makes everything else easy.

📅 DATES

```
Fri 7 May  — MTD quarterly update due
Wed 19 May — CIS return, month to 5 May
Mon 5 Jul  — MTD quarter ends
```

ONE THING: the receipts you are about to hand HMRC for nothing

Every receipt photo sitting in your camera roll, and every crumpled thing in the van, is either a deduction or it is money you did not need to give away.

The ones people consistently lose:

Fuel · parking and tolls · tools under £100 · trade counter purchases on a personal card · PPE and protective workwear · materials paid in cash · phone, at a defensible business share · use of home for the paperwork · subsistence when working away · the Sunday emergency run

None of those are aggressive claims. They are ordinary business costs that go unclaimed because the paper vanished.

THE FIX IS NOT A SYSTEM. IT IS A MOMENT.

Photograph it at the counter, while you are still standing there. Ten seconds. Then forget it.

What does not work: collecting them, sorting them later, keeping them in the glovebox with good intentions. Everyone has tried all three.

MIXED USE, BRIEFLY

Van, phone, home office, workwear. Pick a defensible split, apply it consistently every year, and write down why you picked it. A consistent, defensible number has never been the thing that caused anyone a problem.

Craig

№18 — Thu 13 May 2027

Subject: 20% or 30%? It is not a choice **Preview:** And if you get it wrong, HMRC comes to you.

📅 DATES

```
Wed 19 May — CIS return, month to 5 May
Fri 18 Jun — file the CIS return for the month to 5 Jun (the 19th is a Saturday; work back, the deadline does not move)
Mon 5 Jul  — MTD quarter ends
```

ONE THING: the two minutes that cost contractors the most

Verification. Before the first payment to any subcontractor, you ask HMRC how much to deduct.

HMRC comes back with one of three answers:
  Gross   → 0%   registered for gross payment status
  Net   → 20% registered under CIS. The normal outcome.
  Unmatched → 30% they cannot match them, or they are not registered

THE EXPENSIVE MISTAKE

Paying someone 20% because you assume they are registered, without verifying.

If HMRC's answer would have been 30%, you have under-deducted. HMRC recovers the shortfall from YOU, the contractor, with penalties. You have already paid the money out. There is no mechanism that makes the subcontractor give it back.

Verify first. Every time. Keep the reference number.

IF YOU ARE THE SUBBIE ON 30%

It is not a punishment the contractor chose — if you are unverified they are obliged to deduct 30%. Two things to check: are you actually registered under CIS as a subcontractor (which is not the same as being registered for self assessment), and do your details match exactly? Failed verifications are usually a trading name given instead of the registered name.

The money is not lost either way. But 30% instead of 20% for a year is a lot of your cash sitting with HMRC.

🧮 Free CIS calculator → klyara.com/tools.html

Craig

№19 — Thu 27 May 2027

Subject: Busy, and no money in the bank **Preview:** Four things that drain cash while the P&L looks fine.

📅 DATES

Mon 21 Jun — CIS return, month to 5 Jun
Mon 5 Jul — MTD quarter ends
Sat 7 Aug — MTD quarterly update due

ONE THING: it is almost never a pricing problem

"We are busier than we have ever been and there is no money in the bank." Four things cause it, and none of them show up on a profit and loss.

1. YOUR REAL PAYMENT TERMS

Invoice dated the 30th, terms 30 days, paid on the 15th payment run following. That is 46 days, not 30. Add the eleven days you sat on the invoice and you funded that job for 57.

2. RETENTIONS
Three per cent of everything, held for twelve to twenty-four months. On £400,000 of turnover that is £12,000 permanently out of the business, growing as you grow.

3. THE REVERSE CHARGE
Before 2021 you collected VAT on sales and held it until the quarter end. Never your money, but it was in your account. That float is gone and nobody sent a letter explaining that your working capital had structurally dropped.

4. CIS DEDUCTIONS
20% off every labour invoice, sitting with HMRC until you reconcile. On £120,000 of labour invoicing that is £24,000 lent interest-free, sometimes for a year.

Add those four on a firm turning over £400,000 and you are looking at £50,000–£80,000 of working capital that exists on paper and not in the bank.

You cannot price your way out of it. You can only shorten it: invoice faster, chase harder, claim retentions, move to monthly VAT returns if you are in repayment, and apply for gross payment status if you qualify.

Craig

№20 — Thu 10 June 2027

Subject: The quote that loses the job **Preview:** Usually the fourth day, not the price.

📅 DATES

Mon 21 Jun — CIS return, month to 5 Jun
Mon 5 Jul — MTD quarter ends
Sat 7 Aug — MTD quarterly update due

ONE THING: speed beats polish

Most lost jobs are not lost on price. They are lost on the fourth day.

A quote sent within 24 hours wins substantially more often than the identical quote sent four days later — not because it is better, but because by day four they have two others and you have become the one who seemed less bothered.

Research on how people choose local trades is fairly blunt about this: around three quarters decide within thirty minutes of starting to look, and most evaluate three or fewer businesses. You are not competing to be the best answer. You are competing to be an answer while they are still deciding.

IF YOU CANNOT QUOTE SAME DAY

Send a holding message anyway: "Thanks for seeing me today — I'll have a full quote to you by Thursday." That one text keeps you in it, and it costs nothing.

A NUMBER IS NOT A QUOTE

A figure in a text message gets compared to other figures, which is a competition decided entirely on price. A quote should say what is included, what is not, how long it will take, when you could start, the payment stages, and the number — on a document with your name on it.

The same price presented properly beats a cheaper number in a text more often than people expect. You are not selling the price. You are selling the impression that you will turn up and do what you said.

AND ASK WHY WHEN YOU LOSE

"No problem at all — do you mind me asking, was it price or timing?" Half will tell you. If the answer is consistently timing rather than price, you have been dropping your prices to fix a scheduling problem.

Craig

№21 — Thu 24 June 2027

Subject: Quarter ends 5 July **Preview:** Seven jobs, one a day, and you are done by Sunday.

📅 DATES

⚠ Mon 5 Jul — MTD quarter ends (6 Apr — 5 Jul)
Mon 19 Jul — CIS return, month to 5 Jul
Sat 31 Jul — Second payment on account
Sat 7 Aug — MTD quarterly update due

ONE THING: the seven-job quarter end

Eleven days. One job a day, each under twenty minutes, and the order matters because each makes the next easier.

1. BANK FEED — every business account connected and feeding, not exported and typed. Ten minutes, and it does about eighty per cent of the work on its own.

2. RECEIPTS — everything not already on the feed. One sitting.

3. MIXED USE — van, phone, home, workwear. Consistent, defensible, written down.

4. RECONCILE — zero unmatched. Watch for payments in you never matched to an invoice; that is usually money you already had and were about to chase for.

5. CIS — add up your deduction statements and compare to your records. Chase anything missing now, while the contractor still remembers the job.

6. REVERSE CHARGE — last ten sales invoices, four questions each. Two minutes, highest value on the list.

7. THE NUMBER — margin by job, owed by age, retentions outstanding, bank against thirty days.

Do one a day and you are closed off before the quarter even ends, five weeks ahead of the deadline.

📄 Full checklist, free → klyara.com

Craig

№22 — Thu 8 July 2027

Subject: 31 July, and the payment people forget **Preview:** It lands in the quietest cash month of the year.

📅 DATES

Mon 19 Jul — CIS return, month to 5 Jul
⚠ Sat 31 Jul — Second payment on account
Sat 7 Aug — MTD quarterly update due (6 Apr — 5 Jul)

ONE THING: the July payment on account

Your second payment on account is due 31 July. It is normally half of last year's tax bill, paid in advance, and it arrives in one of the quietest cash months of the year for a lot of building firms.

People remember January. Fewer diarise July, and it is the same size.

IF IT IS UNAFFORDABLE

Talk to HMRC before the deadline, not after. A Time to Pay arrangement agreed in advance is an administrative conversation. The same conversation in August, after a missed payment, comes with penalties attached.

CAN YOU REDUCE IT?

If you genuinely know this year will be lower than last, you can apply to reduce payments on account. Reduce on evidence, not on optimism — HMRC charges interest on the shortfall if you reduce too far.

AND WHEN IT IS PAID

Work out what next January looks like and start putting it aside monthly. A separate account, a standing order, twenty-five to thirty per cent of what lands.

Everyone knows this. Almost nobody does it. The ones who do never have a bad January again.

Craig

№23 — Thu 22 July 2027

Subject: Would you pass the compliance test? **Preview:** Mid-year is the right moment to check.

📅 DATES

```
Sat 31 Jul — Second payment on account
Sat 7 Aug  — MTD quarterly update due
Thu 19 Aug — CIS return, month to 5 Aug
```

ONE THING: gross payment status, checked at the halfway point

One question: have you filed and paid everything on time for the last twelve months? CIS, PAYE, VAT, corporation tax or self assessment.

If the answer is yes, and your construction turnover excluding VAT and materials clears the minimum threshold, you would pass the compliance test for gross payment status.

WHY IT MATTERS

With gross status, contractors pay you in full and you settle your own tax. Without it, 20% of every labour invoice sits with HMRC until you reconcile — up to a year after you earned it, while you are borrowing to buy materials.

On £120,000 of labour invoicing that is £24,000.

THE THREE TESTS

```
Business — you do construction work in the UK through a bank account. Easy.
Turnover — above a minimum, excluding VAT and materials. Check the current figures.
Compliance — twelve clean months. This is the one that catches people.
```

IF YOU FAILED BEFORE

The compliance test only looks back twelve months. A great many firms tried once years ago, failed on a couple of late returns, and would comfortably pass today. Count back twelve months. If it is clean, apply.

AND IF YOU HAVE IT

Keep filing on time. It gets reviewed, and losing it mid-year hurts far more than never having had it, because your cash flow has already adjusted to being paid in full.

Craig

№24 — Thu 5 August 2027

Subject: MTD update due Saturday **Preview:** Ten minutes if your records are current.

📅 DATES

```
⚠ Sat 7 Aug — MTD quarterly update due (6 Apr — 5 Jul)
Thu 19 Aug — CIS return, month to 5 Aug
Tue 5 Oct  — Next MTD quarter ends
```

```
ONE THING: two days

Your quarterly update for 6 April to 5 July is due Saturday.

If you have been keeping records as you go, this is a ten-minute job: check the categories,
submit.

If you have not, here is the fastest legitimate route:

1. Connect the bank feed. It pulls three months of transactions in automatically and that is
   most of the job.
2. Categorise in bulk. Not transaction by transaction — sort by description, select all the
   fuel, categorise in one go. Then the merchants. Then the subbies.
3. Add the cash and personal-card purchases that are not on the feed. Do not hunt for
   perfection; get the significant ones in.
4. Submit.

REMEMBER WHAT THIS IS

A summary of totals. Not a return, nothing to pay, correctable later. Submitting something
reasonable on time beats submitting something perfect late.

IF YOU GENUINELY CANNOT

Submit what you have. The late-submission system works on points, so one late update is not a
disaster — a habit of them is. Then spend August setting it up properly so October is not the
same weekend.
```

```
That is a year of these. Thank you for reading them.

If the answer to all of this is "I need someone to just handle it" — that is what Klyara is.
Bookkeeping, CIS, reverse charge, payroll and the quarterly filing, for a fixed monthly fee
from £59 + VAT. Twenty-minute call, no pitch: klyara.com

Craig
```

After issue 24

The four anchors repeat forever: the 19th of every month, the four MTD update dates, 31 January, and 5 April. Between them they carry roughly half the calendar.

But rewrite these from real conversations. By issue 24 you will have had well over a hundred. The structure holds; the language should be theirs, not mine.

The line that matters

The four anchors repeat forever: the 19th of every month, the four MTD update dates, 31 January, and 5 April.

AT A GLANCE

What is in this part

13 – Thu 4 March 2027

Subject: Five weeks to year end Preview: Five things worth doing before 5 April.

14 – Thu 18 March 2027

Subject: Buying a van before April? Preview: The date on the invoice is worth more than the haggling.

15 – Thu 1 April 2027

Subject: £30,000 from Monday Preview: Measured on what you invoiced, not what you banked.

16 – Thu 15 April 2027

Subject: Your first quarter Preview: Less than the panic suggests.

17 – Thu 29 April 2027

Subject: Ten seconds at the counter Preview: The habit that makes everything else easy.

18 – Thu 13 May 2027

Subject: 20% or 30%? It is not a choice Preview: And if you get it wrong, HMRC comes to you.

PART 14 — The template, and how to load it into Brevo

AT A GLANCE

What is in this part

The eleven template fields

Setting it up, once
Now that klyara.com/tools.html exists, most emails should end with one of these. A free tool outperforms a "bo

The tool block – three ready to paste
Now that klyara.com/tools.html exists, most emails should end with one of these. A free tool outperforms a "bo

The dates block – the format
Two or three lines maximum. A dates box with six lines in it stops being a dates box and becomes a wall.

What the browser test showed
The template renders correctly and on brand: pine header with the lockup, the dates box, the body, one brass b

The signature
email/signature.html is separate and goes into Gmail's signature editor, not Brevo. Paste it into the signatur

Added after the template was tested in a browser. email/template.html is a table-based, inlined-CSS HTML email using the site's own tokens. It has eleven merge fields and they are not the same as the {{FIRSTNAME}} style fields used in the newsletter copy above — these are structural.

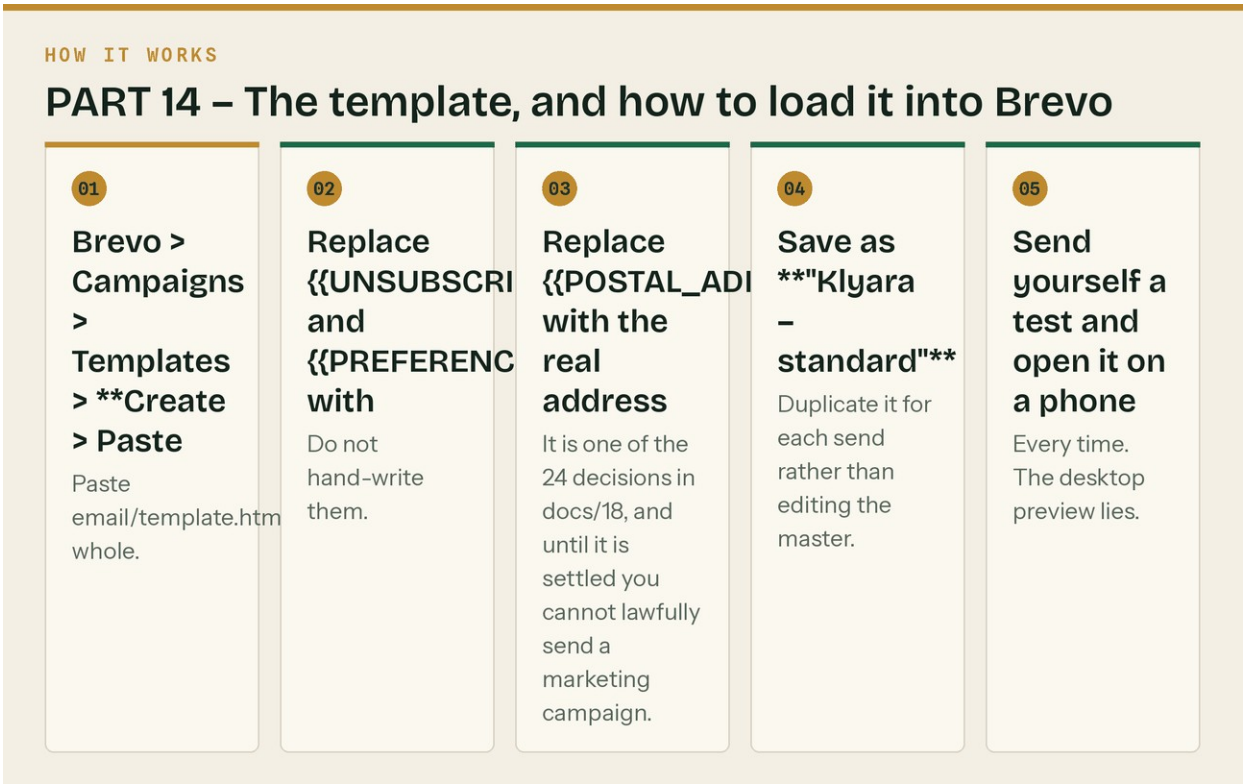
The eleven template fields

FIELD	WHAT GOES IN IT	REQUIRED?
{{TITLE}}	The <title>. Some clients show it; most do not. Use the subject line.	Yes
{{PREVIEW_TEXT}}	The preheader — the grey line next to the subject in the inbox. **This is the second most important thing in the whole email** and it is the one people leave blank. 40–90 characters.	Yes
{{HEADER_LABEL}}	Small mono label top right of the	Optional

	pine header, e.g. "NEWSLETTER 07" or "OCTOBER".	
{{DATES_BLOCK}}	The deadline box near the top. Two or three dated lines. Leave the whole box out for emails with no deadline in them.	Optional
{{BODY}}	The email itself, as <p> tags.	Yes
{{CTA_TEXT}}	Button label. Verb first: "Check your MTD date", not "Click here".	Yes
{{CTA_URL}}	Where the button goes. **One CTA per email.**	Yes
{{TOOL_BLOCK}}	The short block under the divider pointing at a free tool. See below.	Optional
{{POSTAL_ADDRESS}}	A real postal address. **Legally required on marketing email** and non-negotiable.	Yes
{{UNSUBSCRIBE}}	Brevo's unsubscribe merge tag.	Yes
{{PREFERENCES}}	Brevo's preference-centre link.	Yes

Setting it up, once

7. Brevo → Campaigns → Templates → **Create → Paste your code**. Paste email/template.html whole.
8. Replace {{UNSUBSCRIBE}} and {{PREFERENCES}} with Brevo's own unsubscribe and preference tags — they are in the editor's personalisation menu. Do not hand-write them.
9. Replace {{POSTAL_ADDRESS}} with the real address once it is decided. It is one of the 24 decisions in docs/18, and until it is settled you cannot lawfully send a marketing campaign.
10. Save as **"Klyara — standard"**. Duplicate it for each send rather than editing the master.
11. Send yourself a test and open it on a phone. Every time. The desktop preview lies.



The same steps, in order.

The tool block — three ready to paste

Now that klyara.com/tools.html exists, most emails should end with one of these. A free tool outperforms a "book a call" as a secondary action by a distance, and it produces the call a week later anyway.

CIS calculator

```
<strong style="color:#14231C;">Free, no sign-up:</strong> the
<a href="https://klyara.com/tools.html#cis" style="color:#196A48;">CIS deduction calculator</a>
shows what should actually land in your bank, and flags it if you are on 30% rather than 20%.
```

Reverse charge

```
<strong style="color:#14231C;">Not sure about the VAT?</strong> Four questions, ninety seconds:
<a href="https://klyara.com/tools.html#reverse-charge" style="color:#196A48;">do I charge VAT on this
invoice?</a>
It ends on the exact wording to put on the invoice.
```

MTD date

```
<strong style="color:#14231C;">Ten-second check:</strong>
<a href="https://klyara.com/tools.html#mtd" style="color:#196A48;">when does Making Tax Digital start
for me?</a>
It is measured on gross invoices, before CIS, which catches most subcontractors out.
```

The dates block — the format

```
<span style="color:#F4EFE4;">19 October</span>
<span style="color:#87947F;"> &middot; CIS return, month to 5 October</span><br>
<span style="color:#F4EFE4;">7 November</span>
<span style="color:#87947F;"> &middot; MTD quarterly update, quarter to 5 October</span>
```

Two or three lines maximum. A dates box with six lines in it stops being a dates box and becomes a wall.

What the browser test showed

The template renders correctly and on brand: pine header with the lockup, the dates box, the body, one brass button, a divider, the sign-off, and the pine footer with the address, the unsubscribe and the disclaimer.

It is a fixed 600px table, which is correct for email and is what every client expects — at phone width the client scales it, which is the normal behaviour and not the horizontal-scroll problem the web pages had.

The footer now also links to the free tools and the pricing page. Small, in brass, under the contact line. Every marketing email you ever send carries those two links from here on, at no cost.

The signature

email/signature.html is separate and goes into Gmail's signature editor, not Brevo. Paste it into the signature box in Gmail settings — it is deliberately simple because Gmail strips most things. It carries the name, the line, the phone, the email and klyara.com. Do not add a logo image: images in signatures trip spam filters and break in half the clients that receive them.

The line that matters

The footer now also links to the free tools and the pricing page.